Vopak

Durban and Lesedi market sizing

National balance, issue tree and deep dives

South Africa petrol and diesel, Durban-Lesedi corridor

10 October 2026

Public evidence and illustrative capture cases. Customer access, operating limits and returns remain provisional.

Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com



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National petrol and diesel sales were 21.94bn litres in 2023

Year	Domestic production		Gross imports		Exports		Sales		Supply less sales
2019 Energy balance, customs, sales	**19.5B L** Petrol 10.4 · diesel 9.1 **observed · DR01**	+	**7.1B L** Petrol 1.5 · diesel 5.6 **customs · DR01**	−	**2.9B L** Petrol 1.2 · diesel 1.7 **customs · DR01**	−	**23.7B L** Petrol 10.8 · diesel 12.9 **observed · DR01**	=	**0.0B L** Petrol 0.0 · diesel 0.0 **Stocks + stat. difference**
2021 Energy balance, customs, sales	**11.7B L** Petrol 6.4 · diesel 5.3 **observed · DR01**	+	**13.8B L** Petrol 4.0 · diesel 9.8 **customs · DR01**	−	**1.9B L** Petrol 1.1 · diesel 0.9 **customs · DR01**	−	**22.2B L** Petrol 9.3 · diesel 12.9 **observed · DR01**	=	**+1.2B L** Petrol 0.0 · diesel 1.2 **Stocks + stat. difference**
2023 Customs and sales	**Not published** No balance after 2021 Pending · DR08 operators	+	**17.4B L** Petrol 4.5 · diesel 12.9 **customs · DR01**	−	**1.9B L** Petrol 1.0 · diesel 0.9 **customs · DR01**	−	**21.9B L** Petrol 9.0 · diesel 12.9 **observed · DR01**	=	**Cannot close** Needs production Pending · production, stocks

Production fell as imports rose

Production 19.5B L (2019) to 11.7B L (2021)
Imports 7.1B L (2019) to 17.4B L (2023)

DR01 · energy balance, customs

Balance assembled through 2021

Residuals remain, including diesel 2021
Stocks and statistical differences unresolved

DR01 · calculated

2025 trade is available

Gross imports 16.70B L; net 15.15B L
2025 sales and product output unavailable

SARS customs; production and stocks open

Manish DR01, updated 9 Oct: energy balance through 2021; department sales through 2023; SARS customs through 2025. Supply less sales includes stock change and statistical difference. Figures retain their source periods.

Durban and Lesedi market sizing and investment issue tree

p.# Deep dive on that page

1 NATIONAL DEMAND

National consumption p.1
Petrol and diesel sales
2023: 21.94B L
2023 · 21.9B L · observed

Demand by product p.3
Petrol 9.0B L
Diesel 12.9B L
2023 · observed

Demand by use p.4
Road 15.1B, industry 1.6B
Agri 1.2B, other 5.3B
2021 · 23.2B L · balance

Demand parameters p.5
GDP and sectors
EVs, fleet, efficiency
Freight, prices, power

2 SUPPLY AND DELIVERY

Gross imports, 2025 p.1
Petrol 4.45B L
Diesel 12.25B L
2025 gross 16.70B L

Domestic production p.1
Refinery and synfuels
No data after 2021
2021 · 11.7B L · latest

Ports p.6
Durban, Richards Bay
Other gateways
2025 · Durban 13.2B L

Inland delivery p.6
NMPP trunk line
Road and rail
FY25 use 5.46B L/yr

Coastal demand
KZN, WC, EC
Port-adjacent markets
2022 · 10.0B L · proxy

Inland demand
Gauteng and interior
Six inland provinces
2022 · 12.0B L · proxy

Supply and route parameters
Refinery closures, restarts, gas
Delivered cost, routes, contracts
Port, pipeline, rail capacity

3 VOPAK OPPORTUNITY

Market context
2025 Durban customs 13.16B L
Catchments and gateway overlap
Gateway proxy; capture not observed

Durban context
Imports 13.16B L
KZN sales 4.28B L
2025 / 2022 context

Lesedi catchments
Gauteng 6.81B L
Inland 11.95B L
2022 nested demand

Conditional base capture
Durban 2.63B L, Lesedi 1.32B L
Lesedi included in Durban flow
Assumed capture; details p.8

Incremental opportunity
Needs existing throughput baseline
Access and commitments unverified
Pending · DR02/05

4 INVESTMENT

Additional capture
Customers, contracts
Competition
Pending · DR02/05

Existing assets
Tanks and turns
Receipt and dispatch
Pending · DR03

New investment
Volume, capex, returns
Alternatives, downside
Pending · DR06

Resolution
Vopak share by site
Scope for investment

SARS 2025; department sales 2023 and provinces 2022; Transnet Pipelines 2025. Gateway, catchment and terminal throughput are separate measures. No inference of an 8.88B L inland flow from mixed-year subtraction.

Demand by product and province: where the litres are sold

1 COASTAL · 10.0B L

KwaZulu-Natal · 20%
Petrol 1.5 · diesel 2.8B L
Since 2013: +5%
2022 · 4.3B L · observed

Western Cape · 18%
Petrol 1.4 · diesel 2.5B L
Since 2013: +6%
2022 · 3.9B L · observed

Eastern Cape · 8%
Petrol 0.7 · diesel 1.0B L
Since 2013: +9%
2022 · 1.7B L · observed

2 INLAND · 12.0B L

Gauteng · 31%
Petrol 3.5 · diesel 3.3B L
Since 2013: -2%
2022 · 6.8B L · observed

Mpumalanga · 8%
Petrol 0.6 · diesel 1.1B L
Since 2013: -24%
2022 · 1.8B L · observed

Free State · 6%
Petrol 0.6 · diesel 0.8B L
Since 2013: -39%
2022 · 1.4B L · observed

North West · 5%
Petrol 0.4 · diesel 0.6B L
Since 2013: -16%
2022 · 1.1B L · observed

Limpopo · 2%
Petrol 0.3 · diesel 0.2B L
Since 2013: -40%
2022 · 0.5B L · observed

Northern Cape · 2%
Petrol 0.1 · diesel 0.4B L
Since 2013: -23%
2022 · 0.5B L · observed

3 WHAT IT MEANS

Gauteng anchors inland
6.8B L, 31% of the national total
Lesedi's catchment
2022 · observed · DR01

Diesel grew on the coast
KZN 2.3 to 2.8, WC 2.0 to 2.5B L
Petrol fell in every province
2013-2022 · observed

2023 is estimated
First-quarter shares of the total
Error 2.5 pts petrol, 5.3 diesel
Back-test · DR01

Source: Manish DR01 provincial file: department sales by magisterial district summed to province, 2013-2022 observed; 2023 estimated from first-quarter shares. Coastal = KZN, WC, EC (presentation grouping, not registered). Petrol and diesel.

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Demand by use: three sources to calibrate

Source	Road transport	Mining and industry	Agriculture	Power generation	Other and marine
Energy balance 2021, final use	**15.1B L** Petrol and diesel **2021 · energy balance**	**1.6B L** Incl. mining 1.3 **2021 · energy balance**	**1.2B L** Petrol and diesel **2021 · energy balance**	Not in final use Transformation input Pending · none published	**5.3B L** Petrol and diesel **2021 · energy balance**
Model baseline 2024, high demand	**16.4B L** Petrol and diesel **2024 · model, sourced**	**1.5B L** Diesel **2024 · model, sourced**	**1.1B L** Diesel **2024 · model, sourced**	**3.6B L** Diesel **2024; notional plants**	**0.8B L** Marine diesel only **2024 · model, sourced**
Reported separately	No separate series Inside sales totals Pending · none published	No separate series Inside sales totals Pending · none published	No separate series Inside sales totals Pending · none published	**0.89B L** FY25; FY24 1.60B L **Eskom + estimated IPPs**	No separate series Inside sales totals Pending · none published

Years and scopes differ
Balance 23.2B L (2021), model 23.4B L (2024)
Similar totals do not validate sector allocation
To calibrate

Power baseline needs joint review
Engine includes 3,000MW notional plants
Recalibrate power and road together
DR07 · to calibrate

"Other" is large in the balance
5.3B L, mostly commercial and public
The model has no matching segment
To calibrate

Source: department energy balance 2021 (petrol and diesel final consumption); Manish sector baselines (model, high demand, 2024; road petrol and diesel, other sectors diesel); DR07 (Eskom reported litres; independents estimated at 0.31 L/kWh). Not reconciled: overlap log item 6.

Demand parameters: the levers and their 2035 cases

1 ECONOMIC ACTIVITY

GDP growth
Baseline: 0.5% a year
2035: 0.7 / 1.6 / 2
Manish revised 3 of 3 · not accepted

Road freight activity
Baseline: 100 (2024 = 100)
2035: 95 / 135 / 150
Manish revised 1 of 3 · not accepted

Real fuel price
Baseline: 100 (2024 = 100)
Petrol 2035: 80 / 100 / 120
Diesel 2035: 80 / 100 / 140
Added by Manish · not accepted

2 VEHICLE FLEET

Battery EV share of new sales
Baseline: 0.2%
2035: 2 / 15 / 40
Manish revised 3 of 3 · not accepted

New-vehicle efficiency
2035 cases, % a year:
Petrol 1 / 1.25 / 1.5
Diesel 0.5 / 0.75 / 1
Nigel proposal kept · not accepted

Hybrid share of new sales
Baseline: 2.1%
2035: 2.1 / 6.7 / 11.3
Added by Manish · not accepted

3 FREIGHT AND RAIL

Road freight moved to rail
Baseline: 0%
2035: 0 / 7 / 13
Manish revised 2 of 3 · not accepted

Electric share of new trucks
Baseline: not reported
2035: 0 / 3 / 9
Added by Manish · not accepted

Rail passenger journeys
Baseline: 74m a year
2035: 100 / 250 / 320
Added by Manish · not accepted

4 POWER

Diesel turbine output
Baseline: 100 (FY24 = 100)
2035: 5 / 15 / 50
Nigel proposal kept · not accepted

Private backup generation
Baseline: not measured
2035: 0 / 0 / 0.5
Added by Manish · not accepted

Eskom + estimated IPP fuel
FY24 ~1.60B L, FY25 ~0.89B L
Private backup remains unmeasured
Observed and estimated · DR07

Manish proposed lever cases remain unapproved. Implemented EV/efficiency pair reviewed in the 9 Oct handback. Hybrid savings, road activity/rail diversion and inferred fuel/class splits still need rules and calibration.

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Port and logistics system: how fuel reaches coastal and inland demand

1 PORTS AND LIQUID BULK

Port network
Durban 8 liquid-bulk berths
Richards Bay 2; Island View hub
DR04 · TNPA Our Ports

Imports by customs office, 2025
Durban 13.16 of 16.70B L (79%)
Office is a gateway proxy
2025 · petrol, diesel · customs · DR04

All liquids landed, 2025
Durban 20.7 of 31.3M t (66%)
Crude, fuels, gas and chemicals
2025 · TNPA tonnes, all products · DR04

Durban role
Ship receipt; dispatch mainly road
Trunk-line injection to confirm
DR04 · Vopak NERSA filing

2 PIPELINES

Pipeline network
NMPP Durban to Jameson Park
(TM2, 180M L); old DJP retiring
DR04 · Transnet Pipelines 2020

Whole pipeline system, FY25
Petroleum total 13.372B L
Refined petrol/diesel 8.619B L
TPL 2025 p8; different from MPP trunk

MPP usage / capacity, FY25
105 / 148ML per week (70.9%)
Annualised 5.46 / 7.70B L
TPL 2025 p8; shared, not Vopak rights

Lesedi role
4 pipeline intakes, 8 road bays
Customers ship via the trunk line
DR04 · NERSA, Feb 2026

3 RAIL

Rail network
Island View rail gantries
Durban and Matola to Gauteng
Pack research · NERSA 2026

Rail throughput
Durban-Gauteng fuel: not published
Airport jet by rail: 37% to 5%
Pending · Transnet; jet FY18-FY22

Capacity and reliability
Wagon turnaround 33 days
against 14-day design
Pack research · industry, via NERSA

Relevance
Airport jet shifted to pipeline,
rail to pipeline 30:70 to ~10:90
Pack research · NERSA 2026

4 ROAD

Road network
Tankers, coast to inland
Mozambique road imports 0.5%
2025 · customs · DR04

Road and rail volumes
No matched corridor flow series
Mixed-year residual withdrawn
Pending · DR04 open

Cost and constraints
Pipeline tariff 68 to 77 c/l
Gauteng allowance 83 to 91 c/l
2024-26 · NERSA, dept · DR04

Relevance
Shippers moving to road
Sapref: planned import terminal
DR04, DR08 · news, CEF

DR04/08 and Transnet Pipelines 2025 p8, https://www.transnet.net/getFile.ashx?id=6121. 52-week annualisation is arithmetic. MPP, system petroleum, customs and customer flows have different scopes. Average unused capacity is not shipper access.

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Outstanding data for market share and investment testing

Manish assembles public evidence and estimates. Nigel coordinates client requests. Nigel / Henry review scenario settings.

Outstanding request	Status and what remains open	Coordinator	Decision supported
DR01 National balance	Received through 9 Oct: balance assembled to 2021. Residuals and stock changes unresolved; later product production and comparable sales still missing.	Manish Nigel reviews	Current market size
DR04 Routes and access	Received: entry offices, tariffs, access evidence. FY2025 MPP updated. Open: product/customer access, quoted road/rail costs and matched corridor volumes.	Manish Nigel reviews	Accessible market at each terminal
DR07 Demand evidence	Received: power and fleet evidence; implemented EV/efficiency review complete. Open: joint baseline reconciliation and hybrid/rail combination rules.	Manish Nigel reviews	Demand baseline and scenario calibration
DR08 Refinery supply	Received: plant status and operator output, including Secunda FY2026. Open: product yields, Natref ownership basis and stocks; Astron 50/50 split assumed.	Manish Nigel reviews	Domestic output and import requirement
DR02/05 Client capture	36 months of site/product receipts and dispatches, linked transfers, customer destinations and contract volumes.	Nigel coordinates	Current share and achievable capture
DR03 Client operations	Working and committed tanks, turns, occupancy, downtime and receipt/dispatch limits, by site and product.	Nigel coordinates	Usable capacity and bottlenecks
DR06 Investment inputs	Handling/storage terms, operating costs, project capex, timing, tax, working capital and hurdle rate.	Nigel coordinates	Incremental returns and project alternatives

DR09 remains separate: EV adjacency needs customer demand, power access and standalone economics. Nigel coordinates.

Public DR01/04/07/08 handback received through 9 Oct. Client DR02/05/03/06 prepared; sending/receipt not recorded. Review workbook maps all nine requests. No source review or business approval inferred from receipt.

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The base capture screen gives Durban 2.63bn litres and Lesedi 1.32bn within that flow

Illustrative case	Durban bn L	Lesedi bn L	Unique bn L
Low (10%)	1.32	0.66	1.32
Base (20%)	2.63	1.32	2.63
High (30%)	3.50	1.75	3.50

Assumed gateway capture: 10/20/30%. Half of captured Durban flow routes to Lesedi. At two turns/month, Durban's tank screen caps the high case at 3.50bn L. These are conditional total volumes, not measured shares or incremental sales.

2025 Durban customs proxy 13.1605bn L. Registered market_review.yaml: authored sensitivities, no probabilities. Working estimates: Durban 146,000 m^3; Lesedi 124,000 m^3. Customer contestability, product allocation and pipeline access remain unverified. Other-terminal and domestic Lesedi receipts excluded.

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